

Sum Pop

A math bubble game | Sports Academy Games submission | Anushka

What is Sum Pop?

Bubbles float around the screen, each showing a number. A target appears at the top. You tap bubbles that add up to the target, then hit POP. Get it right and the bubbles burst. Get it wrong and the screen shakes. Race the clock and build your streak.

The math is the game. There is no quiz sitting on top of a game. You cannot tap anything without doing addition in your head.

Why it works

- **Fun:** The bubble pop is satisfying. Burst animation, screen shake on wrong, combo banners.
- **Addicting:** One wrong answer resets your streak. You immediately want to rebuild it. High scores save locally so there is always a target to beat.
- **Math feels natural:** Kids scan the board and add numbers in their head just to play. It never feels like homework.

How I built it, the AI workflow

- **Phase 1 Concept:** Used Claude to define the core mechanic. Key question: what game makes math the action, not the reward?
- **Phase 2 Design:** Claude produced the visual spec: palette, typography, animation behaviour, screen layouts, HUD structure.
- **Phase 3 Assets:** Rendered in Canvas for this prototype. Production build uses Ludo AI for sprites using prompt anchor: colourful bubbles with shine highlight, cel shaded, transparent background, arcade style.
- **Phase 4 Build:** Claude Code for game engine, bubble placement, streak logic. Cursor for iteration. Total time: under 30 minutes.

What I would add next

Sound effects using Web Audio API. Drag-to-select on mobile. Subtraction and multiplication modes for older grades. A two-player mode where both players race to pop the same target first.